A Reproducible Workflow for Evidence-Centered Scientific Papers

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Correspondence corresponding.author@stanford.edu · **Code** github.com/SchmiedmayerLab/PaperTemplate · **License** MIT

Abstract

This document demonstrates the standalone preprint presentation supplied with the PaperTemplate repository. The design uses a compact title block, a visible repository link, an integrated abstract, and restrained running elements. It keeps figures and tables visually prominent while preserving a conventional single-column reading experience. The accompanying repository separates manuscript content, evidence, computation, and venue adaptation so each layer remains reviewable.

Keywords scientific writing; reproducibility; LaTeX; research software

1 Introduction

A preprint should look deliberate without resembling a product brochure or a publisher imitation. The default presentation therefore relies on editorial typography and measured spacing rather than institutional branding, mascots, or decorative panels.

The scientific text remains independent of the presentation layer. Authors can retain this design for circulation and preprint release, then disable it when an official venue class controls the submitted manuscript.

The template source and its reference workflow are distributed together in the Paper Template software repository [1].

The manuscript prose, diagram, and table in this specimen are illustrative. The document exists to make the visual system inspectable before it is used for a real paper.

2 A restrained visual system

2.1 Typography and hierarchy

XCharter carries the title, headings, body text, and captions so the manuscript retains a coherent scholarly voice. Source Sans Pro is limited to metadata, running elements, and figure labels. Dark ink carries the argument, muted gray handles secondary information, and Stanford cardinal is reserved for small navigational cues and links.

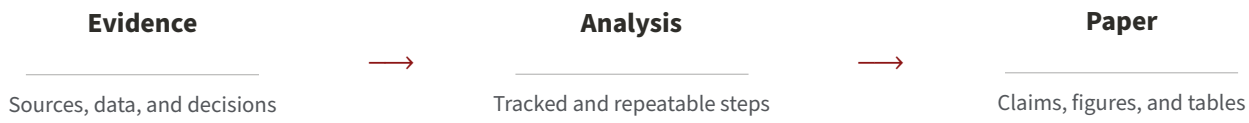


Figure 1. The template keeps the path from evidence to publication visible and reviewable.

2.2 Front matter that starts the paper

The first page groups the title, authors, affiliations, correspondence address, repository, abstract, and keywords. The main text begins on the following page. Long author lists and venue-specific fields can move to an adapted title block without changing the manuscript sections.

3 Reproducibility by default

The repository links foundational inputs, versioned analysis, and publication artifacts. Generated figures and tables declare their inputs and commands, while conceptual diagrams retain editable sources.

Table 1. Default presentation choices and their intended role.

Element	Default treatment	Adaptation boundary
Front matter	Title, authors, and abstract	Adapt fields to the venue
Body text	Single column with measured leading	Change in the presentation profile
Figures and tables	Full-width, reproducible artifacts	Generate from source inputs
Running elements	Short title, rule, and page number	Disable with the preprint profile

The workflow emphasizes three practical checks:

- A clean clone rebuilds public artifacts.
- Every reported value has evidence or an explicit author action.
- Venue changes alter presentation without duplicating content.

4 Adapting the template

Presentation profiles control appearance, while article profiles determine scientific structure. Venue adapters replace the class, front matter, and bibliography rules without duplicating manuscript content.

References

[1] Paul Schmiedmayer. A Reproducible Workflow for Evidence-Centered Scientific Papers. Software repository, 2026. URL https://github.com/SchmiedmayerLab/PaperTemplate. MIT License.